

Brother	Brother
DCP-7065DN	MFC-1811
13990	13100
55.90	42.45
56.23	48.44
42.79	48.49
52.10	46.66
N	N
N	N
Y	N
N	N
2400x600 dpi	1200x600 dpi
2400x600 dpi	600 x 600 dpi
Y	Y
Monochrome LCD	Monochrome LCD
250	150
35	N/A
428 x 397 x 305mm	381 x 361 x 200 mm
11.1	9
A4	Legal
N	Y
Y	Y
175474	137541
315	200
21 / 20	23 / 22
23 / 21	25 / 24
10 / 10	12 / 12
10	22
31	50
11 / 3	14 / 2
94.17	77.08
66.67	54.17
76.47	73.40
50.19	28.57
81.17	61.27
84.03	61.88
86	99
85	75
2500	1775
1200	1500
2.08	1.18
9.08	7.73
5320	2775
12000	10000
0.44	0.28
2660	1665
2.78	2.46

tests, where the outputs were a little more faded than we hoped.

Ricoh also gives the option of a toner refill, drastically cutting down your printing costs in the long run. That said, in terms of pure numbers, the SP203SFN is by far the most expensive printer to run. With the total cost of ownership exceeding ₹11 per page for one year. The SP203SFN only makes sense if you're printing thousands of pages per month. Even if you were to consider toner refills and a three year average print cycle (as we did), the costs come down significantly (₹4 per page) and it's still the highest in this category. Ricoh's remaining two printers aren't so bad in the price per page department and are well below average at approximately ₹2.4 per word.

Brother

There were four MFDs from Brother; the 1511, 1811, 7060D and 7065D. Of these, the DCP 7060D and the 7065DN are by far the better designed and built. Both these printers look and feel solid and generally very professional, sadly, the same can't be said for the DCP1511 and the MFC1811. The printers have a comparatively flimsy input tray and you can't open the flaps for the o/p tray without popping up the entire scan bed.

The problem with these MFDs, unlike the Ricoh ones we mentioned earlier, was the inconsistent results. While the 7060 and 7065 performed very well, choosing the highest quality output would result in prints where the contrast was pumped up way too much, turning finer details into a black mess. Prints at standard quality were easily the best in class. The 1811 was surprisingly

EPSON'S INK TANK

The wild card entry here was Epson with its "ink tank" technology. Something we didn't know much about and whose claims we wanted to see to believe. Epson has been claiming a cost of less than 15p per page for quite some time now and we didn't really buy it. Till we tried out the printer for ourselves that is. The Ink Tank technology is very simple in concept. You have a tank that holds ink (in fluid form obviously) and the nozzles draw ink from that tank and spray it onto the paper.

Now this might sound like any other inkjet printer to you, but the difference here is that you fill up the tanks yourself, with the requisite ink bottle of course, that costs nothing compared to the cartridges and toners that you would normally need. Since you're not purchasing a hunk of plastic and the accompanying circuitry, and considering the fact that the ink bottles contain quite a bit of ink and the fact that you don't need more than a few drops to print a page, the math becomes quite obvious. As you can see from the tables, it really does cost next to nothing to take a printout (not considering the cost of the printer of course). It's an interesting twist to the cartridge saga (the companies are supposed to make their profits on the cartridge sales rather than on the printers after all) and we're curious to see how the strategy works out in the long run and whether we can expect to see such printers popping up among the ranks of HP and Canon and the like.

bad when it came to our point size test and just awful when it came to our sharpness test, with gradients and striations where they should have been none.

The 7065DN was the best in terms of pure text and image quality and the 7060D wasn't very far behind and where the Ricoh printers seemed to struggle a bit when it came to handling large files, the 7060D and 7065DN didn't stutter even slightly. These are

easily the best printers when it comes to volume printing and comparatively heavy print loads. Couple that with the optional drum cartridges that can pump out over 10,000 pages and you've got a very cost effective option on your hands.

When it comes down to pure numbers, the drum cartridges bring down the cost of ownership, at high print volumes, to less than ₹2 per page, which is quite significant.



Brother DCP 7065DN

Panasonic

Panasonic had only one device to offer us, namely the KX-MB1500 SXB. The name may be a mouthful, but the printer is nice and compact. In fact, it's the most compact MFD we received this month. Both paper trays (i/p and o/p) are recessed and built into the body. If space is a constraint then this is definitely the printer for you.